

# Splink in Israel — An Investigation

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*Does Israel use the Ministry of Justice's record-linkage tool? What the public record shows.*

*Public-interest research from publicly available sources, English and Hebrew. Compiled 4 June 2026. A focused single-country deep dive, reported honestly — including the null result.*

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## Headline finding

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**No evidence was found that Israel uses Splink.** Across English- and Hebrew-language searches — the Central Bureau of Statistics (CBS / הלשכה המרכזית לסטטיסטיקה), the Ministry of Health, the four national HMOs, universities, and .gov.il/.ac.il/.org.il domains — **no Israeli institution is documented as using the Splink tool.** This is a **negative result**, stated plainly: Israel is **not** a confirmed Splink adopter and should not be presented as one.

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## What Israel DOES do with citizen data (the real, sourced context)

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Here Israel is actually a *stronger* example of the underlying phenomenon than most — it simply does it with **its own infrastructure**, not Splink:

- **Four nationwide HMOs — Clalit, Maccabi, Meuhedet, Leumit** — hold decades of **linked electronic health records** covering essentially the entire population. Clalit's linked EHR is internationally described as a research "gold mine." (*MobiHealthNews*; *PMC7183366*)
- **Ofek** — Israel's **national Health Information Exchange**, adopted by the Ministry of Health, knits provider records into a **"virtual national health record."** (*PubMed 16160295*; *IADB national HIE report*; *eHealth Governance Country Report: Israel*)
- A **multi-billion-shekel national digital-health programme** explicitly built on the value of this integrated population health data. (*MobiHealthNews*)

So the **practice exists at a very high level of maturity** — population-scale linkage of citizens' health records — but through Ofek and the HMOs' own systems, **not Splink**, as far as any public document shows.

*(Context note, not linkage-related: Israeli health data has also been a breach target — an Iran-linked group claimed to breach Israel's largest healthcare network. Relevant to the data's sensitivity, not to Splink.)*

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## Why the distinction matters

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The honest framing is **not** "Israel runs Splink on its citizens" — unsupported. It's: *"Israel operates one of the world's most integrated population health-data systems (HMO-linked EHRs + the Ofek national exchange) — it links citizen records at scale with its own infrastructure, not the UK's Splink tool."*

If the concern is **citizen-data linkage and consent**, Israel belongs squarely in that conversation — on the strength of Ofek and the HMO data ecosystem — **not** on a Splink connection, which isn't there.

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## Searches run (exhaustiveness)

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1. Splink ... Israel CBS / Ministry of Health — no Israeli adoption.
2. "splink" Israel record linkage / קישור רשומות / CBS / university (incl. Hebrew) — no Splink.
3. Israel health data linkage Clalit/Maccabi/Ofek "splink" — rich native HIE found; no Splink.
4. "splink" site:gov.il OR ac.il OR org.il / Israeli author 2023-2024 — no Israeli-domain Splink hits.

## Verdict

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**Israel: CONFIRMED — no documented Splink use.** Genuine, highly mature citizen-data linkage exists (HMO-linked EHRs, Ofek national HIE); the Splink tool does not appear in the Israeli public record.

## Sources

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- [mobihealthnews.com](https://mobihealthnews.com) — "A 'gold mine' of data... Israel's billion-shekel bet on digital health"
- [pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/16160295](https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/16160295) — Israeli virtual national health record (Ofek)
- [publications.iadb.org](https://publications.iadb.org) — Implementation of a National Health Information Exchange in Israel
- [ehel.org](https://ehel.org) — eHealth Governance Country Report: Israel
- [PMC7183366](https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/27183366) — linked EHRs from a single Israeli healthcare delivery system
- [github.com/moj-analytical-services/splink](https://github.com/moj-analytical-services/splink); [ijpds.org/article/view/1794](https://ijpds.org/article/view/1794) (Splink reference, for what was NOT found in Israel)